

Uddannelsesvalg efter folkeskole



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Dominican Republic. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.
What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's a great and thoughtful question — and it's fantastic that you're already considering your future path at 16. Since you've just finished primary school (which in Denmark usually means *folkeskole* up to 9th or 10th grade), your next step will typically be one of Denmark's upper secondary education options. Let's break down your choices, and I'll give you some advice based on different interests and strengths.

Main educational paths after primary school in Denmark

Gymnasiale uddannelser (general upper secondary education) — preparing for university

- **STX (Studentereksamen)** – Broad general academic program; good if you want to keep options open (sciences, languages, social studies, arts).
- **HHX (Higher Commercial Examination)** – Focuses on business, economics, international trade. Great if you're interested in business, marketing, or entrepreneurship.
- **HTX (Higher Technical Examination)** – Focuses on technology, natural sciences, IT, and engineering.
- **HF (Higher Preparatory Examination)** – Shorter (2 years) and often more practical, good if you want to go to university but prefer a less theoretical route.

When is this a good choice?

- If you enjoy academic subjects and see yourself going to university (for example, to become a teacher, engineer, doctor, designer, or economist).
- If you're not yet sure what you want, STX or HHX can keep doors open.

Erhvervsuddannelse (vocational education and training - EUD) — learn a trade or profession

- Combines school with apprenticeship in a company.
- Leads to qualifications as a carpenter, electrician, chef, healthcare assistant, IT supporter, and more.
- You earn while you learn during the apprenticeship.

When is this a good choice?

- If you enjoy practical work, hands-on learning, and want to start working (and earning) earlier.
- You can still continue to higher education later (via *eux* or supplementary courses).

EUX (combination of vocational + general upper secondary)

- You get both a vocational qualification and study subjects at a level that allows university entry.
- A bit more demanding, but gives both practical skills and academic options.

When is this a good choice?

- If you want the security of a trade and the possibility of university later.

Some factors to consider

- **What subjects do you enjoy most?** Are you more into languages, science, technology, business, arts, or hands-on practical work?
- **Do you want to go to university one day?**
- **Do you like classroom learning or more practical/applied work?**
- **Are you interested in starting to work sooner, or do you want to focus on studies for now?**

My suggestion

Since you're fluent in Danish, have a multicultural background (which can be a real strength!), and you're at a decision point:

- **If you want to keep as many doors open as possible** → consider STX or HHX. STX is great for general studies; HHX could connect well if you're interested in business or international relations (which might fit your Dominican-Danish background).
- **If you love tech/science** → HTX could be great.
- **If you're eager to work sooner or love practical tasks** → consider EUD or EUX.

Other things to explore

- Take advantage of study guidance (*Studievejleder*) at your school or local youth education center — they can help you assess your interests.
- Visit open house events at local *gymnasier* or vocational schools to get a feel for the programs.
- Consider summer schools, internships, or volunteer work to test out fields you're curious about.

 If you tell me more about your interests — for example, what school subjects you enjoy most, or what kind of work you could see yourself doing — I can give you a more specific recommendation! Would you like to share?